Place as a Theme in Art, Literature, Motion Pictures, etc.

H 910

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A. Background

In 1973, the practice of assigning headings of the type ***[name of place]--Description and travel--Views*** or ***[name of place]--Description--Views*** to works consisting of reproductions of art works having a particular place as a theme was discontinued in favor of the use of headings of the type ***[name of place] in art*** as either form or topical headings. In 1997 headings of this type were changed to ***[name of place]--In art***. Phrase headings of the type ***[name of place] in the Bible, etc.***, continued to be used until 2013, when they were largely discontinued in favor of headings of the type ***[name of place]--In the Bible***. They are assigned only as topical headings.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Paintings***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

For guidelines on place as a theme in art, see H 910. For guidelines on artistic photography, see H 1255. For guidelines on illustrations, see H 1659. For guidelines on pictorial works, see H 1935. For guidelines on exhibitions, see H 1593.

B. Recent revisions

2026-04: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. [Place]--In art

Use the free-floating subdivision ***--In art*** as a form subdivision coded $v for reproductions of art works with a specific place as a theme.

Exception: Assign to works that consist of photographs of a place, or of paintings made before the invention of photography merely to give views, the heading ***[place]--Pictorial works***.

LC practice: For collections of art depicting places, assign ***[Place] $x In art*** as a theme. Also assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource. For guidelines on assigning LCGFT to artistic and visual works, see J 210.

Example:

```
Title: Manhattan observed : selections of drawings, prints, and paintings.
    651 #0 $a New York (N.Y.) $v In art.
    651 #0 $a Manhattan (New York, N.Y.) $v In art.
LC practice:
    651 #0 $a New York (N.Y.) $x In art.
    651 #0 $a Manhattan (New York, N.Y.) $x In art.
```

Also use the free-floating subdivision ***--In art*** as a topical subdivision coded $x for works that discuss a specific place as a theme in art.

Example:

```
Title: Michel Delacroix, eternal Paris.
    600 10 $a Delacroix, Michel $x Themes, motives.
    651 #0 $a Paris (France) $x In art.
```

Use of the free-floating phrase heading ***[name of place] in art*** was discontinued in January 1997.

D. [Place]--In literature

Use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--In literature*** under names of places for works that discuss the treatment of a specific place in the various literary genres collectively, or in any individual literary genre.

Example:

```
Title: The Paris of the novelists
   651 #0 $a Paris (France) $x In literature.
   650 #0 $a Fiction $y 19th century $x History and criticism.
```

Note: The standard provisions for literary form headings apply to collections of literature or individual literary works featuring a specific place as a theme, that is, the subdivisions ***--Literary collections***, ***--Fiction***, ***--Drama***, or ***--Poetry*** are used under the place name.

LC practice: In place of the form subdivisions mentioned in the note, instead, assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource.

Use of the free-floating phrase heading *** [name of place] in literature*** was discontinued in August 1993.

E. [Place]--In motion pictures

Use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--In motion pictures*** under names of places for works that discuss the treatment of a specific place in motion pictures.

Example:

```
Title: Hollywood's Canada : the Americanization of our national image.
   651 #0 $a Canada $x In motion pictures.
   650 #0 $a Motion pictures $z United States $x History.
```

Use of phrase headings of the type ***[name of place] in motion pictures*** was discontinued in December 1997.

F. Places in sacred works

Submit proposals to editorially establish headings of the type ***[place]–In the Bible***, ***[place]--In the Vedas***, etc. as needed for works that discuss the treatment of a specific place in a sacred work.

Use of phrase headings of the type ***[name of place] in the Bible*** was discontinued in June 2013.

G. [Place] in […] headings

Submit proposals to establish editorially headings of the type ***[place] in textbooks***, ***[place] in the performing arts***, etc. Assign these as topical headings to works that discuss the treatment of the place in textbooks, the performing arts, etc.

Example:

```
Title: Die Römerzeit im Selbstverständnis der Franzosen und Deutschen.
```

```
650 #0 $a Rome in textbooks.
```

Note: For instructions on assigning names of places as topics of musical works, see H 2075.

Revision history

2026-04: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.